



# 12 Elements of a Shot List

Every director formats their shot list slightly differently, but they all contain roughly the same information, including:

1. **Shot number:** the reference number assigned to each individual shot.
2. **Shot description:** a short description of the action and/or dialogue.
3. **Shot size:** how big or small the subject is in the frame.
4. **Shot type:** the camera angle, or how the camera frames the subject.
5. **Movement:** how the camera does (or doesn't) move within the shot.
6. **Equipment:** the type of camera that captures the shot.
7. **Lens:** the camera lens used to capture the shot.
8. **Frame rate:** the frequency at which the frames are captured.
9. **Location:** where the shot is captured.
10. **Actors:** the actors included in the shot.
11. **Sound:** how the sound and/or dialogue are captured.
12. **Extra notes:** remaining anecdotes the director wants to convey to the crew about the shot.

# How to write a Shot List

A shot list is an important document to a film production, but it's also a creative exercise for the director and cinematographer. It challenges you to think about how particular camera angles can tell the story, make a moment more impactful, or reveal something about a character.

Here's how to create a camera shot list:

1. **Choose a scene** from your script and open a new spreadsheet. The 12 elements listed above are the columns, and each individual shot gets its own row.
2. **Break down** how you want to capture every individual shot in the scene one-by-one. Using your knowledge of shot sizes, shot types, and camera movements, consider how you want to capture each shot and fill in the columns on the spreadsheet accordingly. For example, note where you'll do the establishing shot, where you'll do individual coverage, and where a medium shot or close-up shot may be necessary.
3. Give each shot a **unique number**, starting with 1. Every time you start a new shot, create a new row in the spreadsheet.
4. Make sure you **assign every part** of the scene its own shot.
5. **Draw rough sketches** or a storyboard of your shot list to better visualize how it will come to life and tweak as needed.